Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 6 expectations

Grade 6 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 6 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.6.2, L.6.2a, L.6.2b

A worked example

Add commas: Salem's uncle who works at the port brought back a model dhow.

1. Find the extra information: who works at the port. It adds a detail but is not needed to know which uncle.
2. Extra information that is not essential is set off with a comma before it and a comma after it.
3. Put the commas around the phrase.

Salem's uncle, who works at the port, brought back a model dhow.

Questions

1. Add commas: Maryam who lives in Al Ain won the spelling contest.

   _____

2. Add commas: Khalid's grandfather a retired fisherman tells wonderful stories.

   _____

3. Add commas: The souq I think opens at nine.

   _____

4. Only some of the students finished early, and only those students helped set up the science fair. Which sentence says this correctly? (a) The students, who finished early, helped set up the science fair. (b) The students who finished early helped set up the science fair.

   _____

5. Add commas: The Hope Probe which was built in the UAE reached Mars in 2021.

   _____

6. Which spelling is correct: definately, definitely or definitly?

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7. Which spelling is correct: seperate, separate or separete?

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8. Choose the right word: Everyone will join the trip to the oasis (accept / except) Omar, who has a cold.

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9. Which spelling is correct: neccessary, necesary or necessary?

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10. Punctuate it: Why is the sky so red tonight asked Noura

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11. Add the apostrophes. One teacher owns the desk, and several children own the books: The childrens books were stacked on the teachers desk.

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12. Explain how the meaning changes: (a) My sister, who lives in Dubai, works in a hospital. (b) My sister who lives in Dubai works in a hospital.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.6.1, L.6.1a, L.6.1b, L.6.1c, L.6.1d, L.6.1e, L.6.3, L.6.3a, L.6.3b

A worked example

Choose the correct pronoun: The teacher gave the new books to Hind and (I / me).

1. Take Hind away to test each choice: The teacher gave the new books to (I / me).
2. Gave the books to I does not sound right. The pronoun is the object of the word to, so it needs the object form.
3. So the correct choice is me.

me (the object form is used after the word to)

Questions

1. Choose the right pronoun: Salem and (I / me) built the model rocket.

2. Choose the right pronoun: The teacher gave the certificates to Hind and (she / her).

3. Complete with an intensive pronoun: Noura ____ carried the trophy to the stage.

4. Choose the right pronoun: Hamdan and Omar packed (his / their) bags for the camping trip.

5. Correct the shift in person without changing the first part: When you visit the desert, one should bring plenty of water.

6. Correct the shift in number: Maryam picked a palm leaf and put them in her bag.

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7. Make the pronoun clear: Salem told Khalid that he had won the prize.

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8. Correct the sentence: The two boys was waiting at the metro station.

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9. Combine into one smooth sentence: The market opens at dawn. Fishermen bring in their catch. The market is near the creek.

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10. Which sentence has the more formal tone for a letter to the principal? (a) Hey, can we get a longer break? (b) We would like to ask whether the break could be made longer.

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11. Join the two sentences with 'although': The Hajar mountains are hot in summer. Many people hike there in winter.

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12. Explain what is wrong with this sentence and correct it: Please give the book to Hind or myself.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.6.1, W.6.1a, W.6.1b, W.6.1c, W.6.1d, W.6.1e, W.6.2, W.6.2a, W.6.2c, W.6.2f, W.6.3, W.6.3a, W.6.3d, W.6.5

A worked example

Plan an argument paragraph: should your school have a quiet reading hour each week? Write a claim and two pieces of evidence.

1. Write a clear claim that someone could agree or disagree with: Our school should have a quiet reading hour each week.
2. Evidence 1: reading for a full hour builds children's vocabulary.
3. Evidence 2: a calm hour helps children focus for the rest of the day.
4. Plan a closing sentence that follows from the claim and the evidence.

Claim: Our school should have a quiet reading hour each week. Evidence: it builds vocabulary, and a calm hour helps children focus. Closing: A weekly reading hour would help every child learn.

Questions

1. Which sentence is a claim that can be argued? (a) Dubai has a metro. (b) Every school in the UAE should offer a coding club. (c) The metro opened in 2009.

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2. Which piece of evidence best supports the claim 'Walking to school is good for students'? (a) Some students live far away. (b) Walking is exercise, and exercise helps students concentrate in class. (c) My school bag is blue.

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3. Write a claim for an argument that your school lunch break should be longer.

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4. Put these sentences in order to make an argument paragraph: (1) For these reasons, schools should add solar panels. (2) Schools in the UAE should install solar panels. (3) The country has strong sunshine for most of the year, so panels make a lot of power. (4) This extra power can run the air conditioning without using much oil or gas.

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5. Revise to a formal style: No way is homework good, it is just dumb.

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6. Choose the best linking word: Camels store fat in their humps. ____, they can travel for days without eating. (For example / Therefore / However)

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7. Which is the best introduction for an informative paragraph? (a) I like the Hope Probe. (b) The Hope Probe, the UAE's first mission to Mars, studies the weather in the Martian atmosphere. (c) Mars is red.

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8. Write a concluding sentence for this paragraph: Date palms grow well in hot, dry places. Their roots reach deep for water, and their leaves give shade. Their fruit has been an important food in the region for centuries.

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9. Revise to add sensory details: Omar walked into the spice shop.

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10. Put these parts of a story in the usual order: climax, exposition, resolution, rising action.

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11. Revise to remove repeated meaning: The big, huge crowd was very large at the stadium.

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12. Plan an argument paragraph: should students in your grade take a trip to a desert reserve each year? Write a claim, two reasons with evidence, and a closing sentence.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. Maryam, who lives in Al Ain, won the spelling contest. (the phrase adds extra information, so it is set off by a pair of commas)
2. Khalid's grandfather, a retired fisherman, tells wonderful stories. (a phrase that renames a noun and is not essential is set off by commas)
3. The souq, I think, opens at nine. (a short aside inside a sentence is set off by commas)
4. (b). The words who finished early are needed to tell which students helped, so no commas are used. In (a) the commas would suggest that all the students finished early.
5. The Hope Probe, which was built in the UAE, reached Mars in 2021. (the phrase gives extra information about a probe we already know)
6. definitely
7. separate (remember: there is 'a rat' in separate)
8. except (it means 'but not'; accept means 'to receive or agree to')
9. necessary (one c and two s's)
10. "Why is the sky so red tonight?" asked Noura. (the question mark stays inside the quotation marks, and asked is not capitalised)
11. The children's books were stacked on the teacher's desk. (children is already plural, so 's is added; teacher is one person, so 's is added)
12. In (a) the speaker has one sister, and the phrase only gives extra information. In (b) the phrase tells which sister is meant, which suggests there is more than one sister.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. I (the pronoun is part of the subject; test it alone: I built the model rocket)
2. her (the pronoun is the object of 'to'; test it alone: gave the certificates to her)
3. herself (an intensive pronoun adds emphasis; 'hisself' is not standard English)
4. their (two people are the antecedent, so the pronoun must be plural)
5. When you visit the desert, you should bring plenty of water. (the sentence began with 'you', so it should stay with 'you')
6. Maryam picked a palm leaf and put it in her bag. (one leaf needs the singular pronoun it)
7. A good answer removes the doubt about who 'he' is. Model: Salem told Khalid, "You have won the prize." or Salem told Khalid that Salem had won the prize.
8. The two boys were waiting at the metro station. (a plural subject needs the plural verb were)
9. Model: The market near the creek opens at dawn, when fishermen bring in their catch. (any single, correct sentence that keeps all three ideas is fine)
10. (b). It uses polite, complete wording with no slang or chatty phrases.
11. Although the Hajar mountains are hot in summer, many people hike there in winter. (a comma follows the opening clause)
12. Myself is a reflexive or intensive pronoun and cannot be used as an ordinary object. Correct: Please give the book to Hind or me.

Section 3: Writing

1. (b). It gives an opinion that people could agree or disagree with. (a) and (c) are facts.
2. (b). It gives a reason that directly supports the claim. (a) and (c) do not.
3. A good answer is one clear sentence that states a position. Model: Our school should lengthen the lunch break so that students have time to eat and rest.
4. 2, 3, 4, 1 (claim first, then the evidence, then a closing sentence; sentence 4 says 'This extra power', so it follows sentence 3)
5. A good answer keeps a position but uses formal, respectful wording and a reason. Model: Homework is not always helpful because some tasks take time without teaching anything new.
6. Therefore (the second sentence is a result of the first)
7. (b). It names the topic and tells the reader what the paragraph will explain.
8. A good answer follows from the information and does not add a new fact. Model: Date palms are well suited to desert life and have long been valuable to people.
9. A good answer adds what Omar saw, smelled, heard or felt. Model: Omar stepped into the spice shop, where the warm smell of cardamom and cinnamon filled the air.
10. exposition, rising action, climax, resolution (introduce the characters and setting, build the problem, reach the turning point, then solve it)
11. Model: The huge crowd filled the stadium. (big, huge and large all say the same thing, so one strong word is enough)
12. A good answer has a clear claim, two different reasons each backed by a fact or example, formal wording, and a closing sentence that follows from them. Model claim: Students in our grade should visit a desert reserve each year because they can see wildlife up close and learn how people protect it. Answers will vary.